Marta Ruiz

SR. PRODUCT DESIGNER

Contact

marta.ruizc@outlook.com

Spain · Remote with UK, EU or US teams

marta-ruiz-84880238

Languages

Spanish — Native

English — Professional

Design & Prototyping

Figma · Figma Make · Claude Design · Sketch · Illustrator · Photoshop · InDesign

Research & Testing

UserZoom · Moderated interviews · Unmoderated testing · A/B testing · Accessibility testing

AI Tools

Claude · ChatGPT · Figma Make · Stitch · Perplexity · Scholar AI

Collaboration

Jira & Confluence · Mural · Agile environments

Hi! I'm Marta Ruiz, a Senior Product Designer

10+ years in design, based in Spain. For 5+ years I was embedded in Kroger's product org via Empathy.co, designing the search and ads experiences that tens of millions of people use for their grocery shopping. I'm happiest when I'm close to the people I design for: research and testing are at the core of my work, and I'm comfortable explaining my design decisions to senior stakeholders up to Director/VP level. I like to get involved early, from research and requirements to wireframes, high-fidelity screens and launch.

Outside design, I love spending time with my family and running 10Ks and half marathons. Open to full-time senior roles, remote from Spain with UK, EU or US teams, and happy to travel.

What I bring

Discovery	I plan and facilitate discovery sessions to frame problems and uncover opportunities.
Research & testing	I write research plans and run unmoderated usability tests, and support research teams with moderated ones.
Facilitation	I lead workshops and meetings, keeping teams and stakeholders aligned.
Planning	I plan design roadmaps, size the work for each quarter and break it into sprints.
Design & prototyping	From quick wireframes to high-fidelity prototypes, covering every flow and edge case.
AI-assisted design	I integrate AI as a tool across the design process, from research to ideation and design, to work more effectively. Certified in AI for UX Design.

Professional Experience

Nov 2020 – Mar 2026

Product Designer · Kroger (contractor via Empathy.co)

Cincinnati, US · Remote from Spain (CET) — 5+ years collaborating with US-based teams across timezones

Monetisation Ads · Lead Product Designer (2023–2026)

Owning the full design process across every project, from discovery through developer handoff (web, iOS & Android), collaborating closely with the Product Manager and Senior Management to align on business objectives and product guidelines.

- Led end-to-end design of new ad formats shipped at scale, driving measurable revenue impact for Kroger and brand partners (specific figures under NDA).
- Designed sponsored product carousels — one of the team's highest-impact launches — plus a video ad format with carousel, including a screen-reader accessibility evaluation.
- Prototyped new ad types and tested them with 100 shoppers, 40 brands and 5 moderated interviews — the findings put sponsored carousels first.
- Made ad formats responsive and accessible (live text instead of flat images), added dynamic price tags to ads, and brought sponsored content into homepage campaigns.
- Presented regularly to Director/VP-level stakeholders across cross-functional teams of 6–15.

Search experience (2020–2023)

Three years designing across Kroger's search experience — search results, filters, navigation and product discovery on web, iOS and Android. I started alongside the Lead Designer and took on projects independently as my role grew. **Selected highlights:**

- Redesigned Kroger's core search, used by **tens of millions** of customers across web and app.
- Cut broad-query result sets by **80%** (1,000+ → ~160) through iterative design and A/B testing, lifting add-to-cart conversion and revenue.
- Shipped a coupons carousel and inclusive filter chips (dietary, savings, price range) from user-research insights — significant uplift in filter engagement.
- Designed product carousels and visual category shortcuts that helped shoppers browse and refine results.

Jan 2016 – Aug 2020

Visual Designer · AlfaPeople

London, UK

- Lead designer for all marketing and brand materials across a **9-country** organisation — owning layout, visual direction, and execution.
- Led the company's first social-media templates and a full rebrand (new brand identity and website).

Parallel to this role, pursued UX certifications and transitioned deliberately into product design — joining Empathy.co as a UX/UI Designer in 2020.

Education

2013 – 2014

PG Certificate — Design for Visual Communication
University of the Arts London

2006 – 2010

BSc Honours — Industrial Design & Multimedia Engineering
CESINE University, Spain

Certifications

May 2026
AI for UX Design
Designlab

Nov 2025
Accessibility Design Heuristics
Level Access

Oct 2025
Strategic Business Acumen for Designers
Designlab

Sep – Oct 2020
UX: Research & Prototyping
UC San Diego

Oct 2015
UX for the Web
Open University of Australia

Recommendation

"Marta is a fantastic designer with an exceptional eye for detail and a thoughtful approach to solving the right problems. She brings a strong customer-first mindset and uses data to inform her design decisions and conversations with stakeholders."

Nicola Cimino · Product & Experience Leader, Kroger · March 2026

Full recommendation visible at linkedin.com/in/marta-ruiz-84880238